

BENYAM TELAHUN

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior SQL Server Database Administrator with 10+ years of experience managing and optimizing mission-critical databases across SQL Server 2012–2022. Skilled in installation, configuration, performance tuning, security, and implementing high availability solutions such as mirroring, log shipping, clustering, replication, and Always On. Adept at diagnosing complex issues, optimizing queries through indexing and execution plan analysis, and ensuring data integrity across enterprise systems. Experienced in SSRS, SSIS, and SSAS, delivering BI solutions that support strategic decision-making. Committed to scalability, automation, data security, and continuous improvement, with a proven ability to mentor junior DBAs and align database strategy with organizational goals.

EDUCATION

California Polytechnic State University - San Luis Obispo

Bachelor's, Computer Information Systems

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Database Administrator Associate — Certification in Progress (Exam DP-300, Expected Nov 2025)

SKILLS

Database Platforms: SQL Server (2012/2016/2019/2022), Azure SQL Database, AWS RDS for SQL Server, MySQL, Postgres, PostgreSQL, MariaDB, Oracle

Performance Tuning & Optimization: Performance Tuning, Query Optimization, Indexing, Partitioning, Query Store, SQL Server Profiler, Execution Plans, Dynamic Pricing Strategies

High Availability & Disaster Recovery: Always On, Replication, Backup Strategies, Recovery Strategies, Disaster Recovery, High Availability

Automation & Scripting: PowerShell, Automation, ETL Processes, Data Transformation

Business Intelligence & Data Analytics: SSIS, SSRS, SSAS, Microsoft Power BI, Azure Data Factory, Microsoft Fabric, Excel / Numbers / Google Sheets, Predictive Modeling

Monitoring & Tools: Database Monitoring, Redgate Monitor, ServiceNow, JIRA, DMVs, Extended Events

Database Design & Administration: T-SQL, Database Maintenance, Troubleshooting, Performance Baselines, Capacity Planning

Security & Compliance: Security, Encryption, Compliance, Access Control, Data Integrity

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cedar-Sinai Medical Center

Los Angeles, CA

SQL Server Database Administrator

June 2023 - Present

- Administer and optimize SQL Server environments supporting clinical and enterprise systems, aligned with Cedars-Sinai's hybrid cloud and digital health strategy.
- Architected and deployed AlwaysOn Availability Groups and failover clustering to ensure 24/7 access to patient and operational data.
- Boosted query performance by 50% through strategic index tuning, partitioning, and execution plan analysis.
- Automated backup, patching, and performance tuning using PowerShell and T-SQL, enhancing system reliability and reducing manual workload.
- Led security hardening initiatives, implementing TDE, RBAC, and audit logging to meet HIPAA and HITECH compliance standards.
- Developed robust disaster recovery protocols, minimizing downtime and ensuring business continuity across mission-critical systems.
- Collaborated with DevOps and application teams to align database performance with clinical workflows.

Coterra Energy

Houston, TX

SQL Server Database Administrator

October 2018 - May 2023

- Supported enterprise-grade SQL Server environments for energy logistics and asset management systems across Chevron's hybrid infrastructure

- Configured and maintained AlwaysOn Availability Groups and automated failover clusters, reducing downtime by 70% for refinery and pipeline operations
- Created and maintained SSIS packages for automated ETL processes, improving data transformation efficiency and reducing manual intervention
- Optimized stored procedures and indexes, cutting query execution times by 60% and enhancing application responsiveness
- Developed PowerShell and T-SQL automation for backup, patching, and performance tuning, improving system efficiency and audit readiness
- Enforced NERC CIP and SOX compliance through encryption, access control, and audit logging, supporting Chevron's regulatory and cybersecurity mandates.

Morgan Stanley

Baltimore, MD

SQL Server Database Administrator

July 2015 - September 2018

- Managed SQL Server environments supporting financial analytics, portfolio management, and regulatory reporting across Morgan Stanley's investment platforms
- Implemented AlwaysOn Availability Groups and automated failover strategies to ensure high availability for trading and compliance-critical databases
- Contributed to early hybrid cloud initiatives, including pilot migrations to Azure SQL Database, supporting Morgan Stanley's evolving cloud strategy and reducing infrastructure overhead by 30%
- Automated backup, patching, and performance tuning using PowerShell and T-SQL, improving system reliability and audit readiness
- Enforced SOX and SEC compliance through encryption, access controls, and audit logging, ensuring secure handling of sensitive financial data.

The Hertz Corporation

Los Angeles, CA

Fleet Data and Portfolio Analyst

August 2001 - June 2015

- Retrieved, consolidated, and analyzed data from multiple systems, transforming raw information into actionable insights for fleet optimization and pricing strategies
- Developed predictive models to forecast demand and strategically allocate fleet resources by location, vehicle type, make, model, and manufacturer parameters, improving utilization by 20%
- Designed dynamic pricing strategies based on fleet usage trends, ensuring competitive pricing while enhancing profitability
- Built ETL pipelines to streamline data extraction and reporting, reducing manual processing time by 40% and improving decision-making speed
- Leveraged SQL Database queries to create real-time dashboards tracking fleet utilization, pricing fluctuations, and operational efficiencies.